

EKKO

The Boy Who Shattered Time

Archetype: **Mixup** | Region: **Zaun**

COMPLETE GUIDE

Frame Data · Combos · Mixups · Matchups · Team Synergies

Sources: [Mobalytics.gg](#) · [Games.gg](#) · [2xko.wiki](#) · [2xko.riotgames.com](#)
Season 1 (Version 1.1.3) — March 2026

“It’s my time.” — Ekko

CONTENTS

Chapter 1

CHAMPION OVERVIEW

1.1 Who is Ekko?

Ekko is a prodigy from the rough streets of Zaun who manipulates time using his own invention, the **Z-Drive**. In 2XKO he occupies the **Mixup archetype**, thriving on pressure and burst mobility. Unlike characters who rely on raw power, Ekko rewrites the rules of each engagement through temporal tricks—afterimages, looping projectiles, and position-swapping teleports.

His kit rewards creative thinking, adaptation on the fly, and deep knowledge of the opponent's defensive habits. He can play the role of an aggressive rushdown fighter *or* a patient zone-controller depending on his Timewinder and afterimage state.

1.2 Strengths and Weaknesses

Strengths

- Huge arsenal of mixup tools — opponents rarely know which direction to block
 - Extremely versatile: rushdown *and* zoning are both viable
 - Fast, far-reaching Forward Assist hard to react to
 - Outstanding okizeme with Timewinder oki setups
 - Great team support — both assists are
- highly effective in neutral and combos
 - Good meter gain, especially from Chrono-break loops
 - High creativity and room for player expression
 - Punishing counterplay against parry with S2 Hold bait

Weaknesses

- Loses poke battle against true zoners
- High skill floor AND ceiling
- Short normal range — must stay extremely close
- Anti-air is genuinely poor; 2H is unreliable
- Temporal Slip (6S1) has a gap and is punishable on block
- Cannot Replay out of failed throws (Season 1 nerf)
- Backdash slowed in Season 1 — retreat is less evasive

Chapter 2

MOVE LIST REFERENCE

2.1 Notation Guide

Ekko guides use **numpad notation**. Think of a numpad: 5 = neutral, 6 = forward, 4 = back, 2 = down, 8 = up, 9 = up-forward (jump). **jc.** = jump cancel, **[X]** = hold input, **r.** = rewind follow-up.

2XKO Button Notation Reference

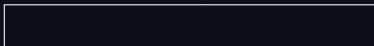
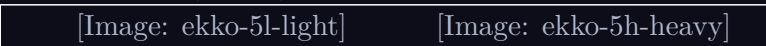
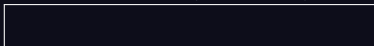
				
	Light	Medium	Heavy	Throw
	Super 1	Super 2	Down	Forward
	Back	Up	Plus	 Next

Symbol	Meaning
>	Cancel/chain from previous move
,	Link previous to next
~	Follow-up/cancel into multi-stage move
dl./delay	Delay the following move
j.	Jumping attack
jc.	Jump cancel
land	Must land before continuing
[X]	Hold input X
r.S2	Rewind to normal Afterimage
r.2S2	Time's Up rewind

2.2 Normal Moves

Input	Name	Notes
5L	Standing Light	6f startup; fastest poke
2L	Crouching Light	7f startup; good chain starter
5M	Standing Medium	10f; main combo tool
2M	Crouching Medium	10f; lower hitbox option
5H	Standing Heavy	13f; +1 on hit
2H	Crouching Heavy	13f; launches; advancing anti-air
66H	Step Up (run H)	13f; +10 on hit, +1 on block

2.2.1 Move Demonstrations

Ekko's 5L (Light)	Ekko's 5H (Heavy)
	
Replace with game screenshot	Replace with game screenshot
Ekko's 66H (Step Up)	Ekko's 2H (Anti-air)
	
Replace with game screenshot	Replace with game screenshot

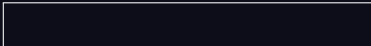
2.3 Command Normals

Input	Name	Notes
3L	Heel Tap	Quick longer-range LOW. 9f startup; 15f hitstun (Season 1 buff). Best low poke.
3M	Flip It	Overhead. 22f startup; +5 hit, -3 block. Combo-able with Volatile Afterimage active only.
66H	Step Up	H while running. Scaling now +1 instead of +3. Strong pressure extender.

2.4 Special Moves

Input	Name	Notes
5S1 / j.S1	Timewinder	Primary neutral projectile. Slows near max range; Time-slow on hit. AIR OK. Can be batted with H.
2S1	Timewinder Toss	Arcing lob; ideal for oki setups.
6S1	Temporal Slip	3-hit advancing strike. Gap between hits 2–3. Punishable on block by mediums.
5S2 / j.S2	Chronostrike	Creates Afterimage; teleports back with attack. HOLD for Volatile Afterimage. AIR OK.
6S2	Chronostrike Forward	Creates a <i>new</i> clone rather than returning to existing one.
3S2	Chronostrike Down-Forward	Clone with downward arc; jump-cancelable on hit.
2S2 (Volatile)	Chronobreak	OTG pickup; wall bounce for corner carry. Air/ground. Only with Volatile Afterimage.
r.S2	Replay	Follow-up to normal Afterimage.
r.2S2	Time's Up!	Follow-up; hold back to move backwards. 50/50 with Temporal Slip hit 3.

2.4.1 Key Special Move Gameplay

Timewinder (S1)	Chronostrike (S2)	
		
Replace with game screenshot	Replace with game screenshot	Replace with game screenshot
Afterimage Rewind	Chronobreak OTG	
		
Replace with game screenshot	Replace with game screenshot	Replace with game screenshot

2.5 Throw

Input	Name	Notes
6T	Forward Throw	Hard knockdown; enables corner Timewinder trap.
2T	Tag Launcher	12f startup; launches for team extension.

2.6 Supers and Ultimate

Input	Name	Notes
S1+L/M/H	Mega Timewinder	Enhanced projectile; boomerangs midscreen. First hit now causes damage scaling (Season 1). Continues traveling when parried.
S2+L/M/H	Tangled Timeline	Grants Volatile Afterimage for 5 moves (install super). Core for highest-damage routes.
S1+S2	Attempt #37 (3 bars)	Massive damage. Counter-hit grants bonus damage. Blockstun reduced 6f in Season 1.

2.7 Assist Moves

Input	Name	Notes
T	Chronostrike Assist	Quick strike. Startup now 19f (was 17f). No longer gapless when doubled. Range and hitbox reduced.
4T	Timewinder Assist	Projectile with slow. Startup now 22f (was 16f). Best at max range for Time-slow control.
2T	Mega Timewinder Assist	Enhanced Timewinder for stronger space control.

Chapter 3

FRAME DATA

3.1 Normal Moves Frame Data Table

All values reflect Season 1 (Version 1.1.3, March 2026). 60fps; 1 frame $\approx$ 16.67ms.

Move	Startup	On Hit	On Block	Notes
5L	6	+0	-1	Fastest normal; go-to pressure button
2L	7	-1	-2	Safe poke; low option
3L	9	-1	-2	Heel Tap LOW; longer range; 15f hitstun
5M	10	-4	-5	Punishable on block; use mid-string only
2M	10	-2	-3	Slightly safer medium
3M	22	+5	-3	Overhead; combo-able with Volatile Afterimage
5H	13	+1	-3	Solid advancing poke
2H	13	Launch	-5	Anti-air; lingering hurtbox during recovery
66H	13	+10	+1	Step Up; only plus on block normal
2T	12	Launch	-6	Tag Launcher

3.2 Reading the Frame Data

Startup: Frames before the attack becomes active. Lower = faster.

On Hit: **Positive values** = your turn to continue pressure. **Negative** = opponent acts first.

On Block: **-6 or less** = punishable by light attacks. **-3 to -5** = punishable by fast moves. **-1 to -2** = mostly safe.

Launch = sends opponent airborne; enables air combo.

3.3 Practical Frame Data Notes

- **5L** at **-1** on block is safe — always safe to throw out.
- **5M** at **-5** on block is punishable — never end block strings with this.
- **66H (Step Up)** at **+1** on block is Ekko's only plus on block normal — frame trap after this.
- **3M (Flip It)** at **+5** on hit: massive advantage — confirm into combo when Volatile Afterimage is active.
- **Temporal Slip (6S1)**: gap between hits 2 and 3 can be parried, and it is punishable by most medium attacks on block. Never throw out raw.
- **2H** has a lingering hurtbox during recovery frames — whiffing this in neutral is dangerous.

Chapter 4

UNIQUE MECHANICS

4.1 Afterimage System

4.1.1 Normal Afterimage (Uncharged S2)

Using **5S2**, **3S2**, or **j.6S2** creates a **normal Afterimage** at Ekko's position, then teleports him back. Follow-up options:

- **r.S2 (Replay)** — teleports back to the afterimage with an attack
- **r.2S2 (Time's Up!)** — returns with downward launcher; hold back to retreat instead

Afterimage Rewind Examples

[Image: ekko-afterimage-examples]

4.1.2 Volatile Afterimage (Hold S2 until frame 18+)

Holding **S2** to at least frame 18 charges a **Volatile Afterimage**, unlocking:

- **Chronoswitch** — teleport without attacking, maintaining neutral position
- **Chronobreak (2S2)** — OTG pickup with wall bounce for corner carry
- **Flip It (3M)** becomes combo-able into full routes
- Essential for all of Ekko's highest-damage sequences

Down S2 (2S2/3S2) is the fastest and safest way to set up a Volatile Afterimage. It is also **projectile-invulnerable** — it passes through Jinx rockets and other projectiles.

4.1.3 Afterimage Cancel

Once any S2 Special or S2 Super has been used, virtually every move can be cancelled into an Afterimage follow-up. This makes opponents extremely hesitant to use Parry or Pushblock — they cannot be certain whether Ekko will attack or rewind.

4.2 Timewinder Mechanics

4.2.1 Distance-Dependent Properties

- **Early/close hit:** Standard juggle for basic conversions
- **Max-distance (slowed):** Applies a **Time-slow reaction** — gives a generous window to follow up for a big combo (Ekko or Assist)

[Image: ekko-timewinder-mechanics - Timewinder distance-dependent properties]

4.2.2 Batting Timewinder

Heavy buttons can redirect the Timewinder mid-flight:

- **H** — launches it forward
- **2H** — sends it upward in an arc
- **3H** — arcing downward trajectory

Mirror Matchup: You can hit an opponent's Timewinder back at them with your own heavy attacks to redirect it. This does **NOT** work with the Mega Timewinder Super.

4.3 Air Hop

Ekko's Air Hop (**L+M** or **66** in the air) is a unique **forward-only short hop**. It cannot be performed backwards. Use it to:

- Bait out anti-airs in neutral before confirming on the opponent
- Cross up opponents and sandwich with Assist
- Mix empty jump into throw, jump H, or Air Hop cross-up to confuse defensive options

Chapter 5

NEUTRAL GAME

5.1 Core Neutral Pillars

1. **Timewinder control** — force opponents to respect the screen at all ranges
2. **Clone threat** — a Volatile Afterimage's mere presence changes opponent defensive habits
3. **Mobility and positioning** — Air Hop and dash to maintain optimal spacing

5.2 Key Neutral Buttons

- **5S1 (Timewinder)** — primary space control; throw at max range for Time-slow reaction
- **5L** — fastest check; interrupt opponent movement
- **3L (Heel Tap)** — longer-range low; superior poke versus **2L**
- **5H** — solid advancing poke; **+1** on hit
- **66H (Step Up)** — **+10** on hit, **+1** on block; best pressure button
- **j.H** — jump-in; mix with empty jumps to condition anti-airs

5.3 Timewinder Okizeme

After hard knockdowns and Limit Strikes, use **2S1** to lob a Timewinder that floats down onto the waking opponent.

5.3.1 Corner Throw Oki Trap

1. Land **Forward Throw** in the corner
2. Immediately input **2S1**
3. Timewinder traps opponent — they cannot Getup Attack; it hits and slows them even if Ekko is hit
4. Free mixup: choose tick-throw, left/right with **2S2**, block string into overhead, or Assist sandwich

Cycling through different oki patterns conditions opponents to freeze on wakeup. Then punish with the overhead.

5.4 Approach Tactics

- **Roll:** Invincibility frames allow passing through horizontal projectiles to close distance
- **Air Timewinder:** Jump and throw **j.S1** to beat grounded anti-airs
- **Down S2 crossup:** Projectile-invulnerable; crosses up at close range before Assist arrives
- **Timewinder cover:** Fire **2S1** then dash forward — opponent blocked the projectile while you close in

Chapter 6

MIXUP SYSTEM

6.1 Core Mixup Tools

6.1.1 S2 HOLD vs. Immediate S2

Chronostrike can be held for Volatile Afterimage or released immediately, creating a commitment guessing game:

- Release immediately: Attacks come out; blocking opponent takes the hit
- Hold: Bait the Parry, then punish with **2S2** Chronobreak

On block, **S2 Hold** crosses Ekko behind the opponent. His **5L** is fast enough to contest reversals:

Situation	Result	Opponents
Ekko 5L after cross	TRADE	Jinx, Warwick
Ekko 5L after cross	WIN	Braum, Blitzcrank, Darius, Illaoi

6.1.2 Down S2 Sandwich

1. Begin charging **2S2**
2. Call Tag Assist
3. Ekko crosses the opponent *before* the Assist arrives
4. Opponent must block in the opposite direction — nearly unreactable left-right

6.1.3 Flip It Overhead (3M)

Flip It is reactable on its own (22f startup). In blockstrings and with Assist pressure, it becomes deadly. Conditioning sequence:

1. Multiple block strings with **2L**, **3L** (condition to crouch-block)
2. Land **Flip It** when they expect low
3. With Volatile Afterimage active: confirm into full combo

6.1.4 Temporal Slip 50/50

The gap between Temporal Slip hits 2 and 3 enables:

- Normal Afterimage active: use **Time's Up!** to catch Parry attempts
- Hold Down-Back during gap: disengage, making hit 3 a frame trap
- This 50/50: *Time's Up* vs. *Temporal hit 3*

Temporal Slip on block is punishable by most mediums. Never use raw in block strings without afterimage backup.

6.2 Jump Mixup Triangle

Option	Beats	Loses to
Empty jump into throw	Crouch blocking	Reversal or throw tech
Jump j.H	Reversals / stand-block	Well-timed anti-air
Jump into Air Hop (cross-up)	Anti-air timing	Quick block change

6.3 Corner Throw Trap Full Sequence

1. Land **Forward Throw** in corner
2. Input **2S1** immediately — Timewinder floats down on wakeup
3. Opponent cannot Getup Attack
4. Choose: low, overhead, left/right, tick throw, or Assist sandwich
5. On hit: confirm into combo; on miss: reset the loop

Chapter 7

COMBO GUIDE

7.1 Pulse Fuse Combos (Beginner)

Triggered by the **Pulse Fuse**; no strict timing required.

[Image: ekko-combo-structure - Combo flow diagram]

Pulse Combo — Ground Starters

Visual Input	Dmg	Diff
> > > > > > >	237	Very Easy
> > ~ >	358	Very Easy
> >	439	Very Easy

Pulse Combo — Air Starters

Visual Input	Dmg	Diff
> > >	181	Very Easy
> > > land > >	338	Easy
> ~ > land >	464	Very Easy

7.2 Beginner Combos

Beginner — S1 Super Finisher (anywhere)

Combo Input Sequence:

> > > > jc. > > > >

- 5L > 5M > 5H > 2H > jc. > j.M > j.H > j.S1 > S1+L
- Works everywhere on screen.
- At midscreen: Mega Timewinder boomerangs back; extend with j.H.
- Without meter: end with 6S2 instead for oki reset.

Visual Reference: [Image: combo-ekko-s1-finisher]

Beginner — S2 Super Finisher (anywhere)

Combo Input Sequence:

> > > > > > land >

- 5L > 5M > 5H > 6S2 > 2S1 > j.6S2 > land > 2S1
- Primary meterless BnB.
- The Limit Strike gives time to set up Tangled Timeline or 2S2 Volatile pressure.
- **Hold forward** during the final air S2 or Ekko rewinds away from the opponent.

Visual Reference: [Image: combo-ekko-s2-finisher]

Beginner — Timewinder Confirm (anywhere)

Combo Input Sequence:

> dash > > > > > jc. > > >

- 5S1 (distance/slow hit) > dash > 5L > 5M > 5H > 2H > jc. > j.M > j.H > j.S1
- Time-slow reaction gives a generous follow-up window.
- Practice dashing forward and confirming with 5L on reaction.

Visual Reference: [Image: combo-ekko-timewinder-confirm]

7.3 Intermediate Combos

Intermediate — 3L Starter (anywhere)

Combo Input Sequence:

> > > > > > > >

- 3L > 5M > 5H > S2~S2 > 2L > 5M > 5H > 3H > 9 > j.H > j.S2 > 5H > 3H > 9 > j.H > j.S2 > 2S1
- Starts from Heel Tap low poke; confirms into rewind chain.

Visual Reference:  [Image: combo-ekko-3l-starter]

Intermediate — 2L Starter (corner)

Combo Input Sequence:

>>>>>>66>>>>**T**

- 2L > 5M > 5H > 3H > 9 > j.5H > 66 > j.5H > j.5S2 > 5H > T
- Corner-specific. The dash cancel (66) after the first airborne j.H is the key timing.
- Ends with Tag Launcher for partner extension.

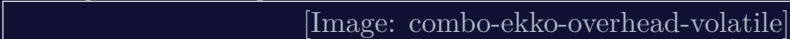
Visual Reference:  [Image: combo-ekko-2l-corner]

Intermediate — Overhead into Volatile (anywhere)

Combo Input Sequence:

>>r.>>>jc.>>>

- S2+L (install) > 3M > r.S2 > 5H > 2H > jc. > j.M > j.H > j.6[S2] > 2S2 > 3H > jc. > j.H > j.S2
- Requires Tangled Timeline installed to make Flip It combo-able.
- Volatile Afterimage from charged air S2 feeds the Chronobreak OTG pickup.

Visual Reference:  [Image: combo-ekko-overhead-volatile]

7.4 Advanced Combos

Advanced — 6T Starter (anywhere)

Combo Input Sequence:

T>**T**>66>>>>>>

- 6T > T > 66 > 5M > 5H > 3S1 > 22S1 > S1 > 3S2 > 3H > 9 > j.[H] > j.2S1 > S2 > 3H > 9 > j.H > j.S2 > 5H > T
- Solo conversion from Forward Throw using Chronobreak OTG.
- Charged airborne H (j.[H]) before j.2S1 is the high-damage battery segment.
- Ends with Tag Launcher for further partner extension.

Visual Reference:  [Image: combo-ekko-6t-starter]

Advanced — Corner Ult Finisher

Combo Input Sequence:

>>>>>jc.>>>>land>>>

- 5L > 5M > 5H > 3S2 > 2H > jc. > j.M > j.H > j.6[S2] > land > 2S2 > 5H > S1+S2 (Ultimate)

- Corner-specific high-damage ender.
- After final **j.H** alternates: **S1+L** Super, **T** Tag Launcher, or **2H > j.S2** oki.

Visual Reference:

[Image: combo-ekko-corner-ult]

7.5 Corner Carry Routing

Use **Chronobreak (2S2)** wall bounce to send opponents into the corner. Adding **6S2** (new clone forward) mid-combo carries the opponent across the screen before the wall bounce.

- After launcher: **j.c.** > **j.M** > **j.H** > **j.6[S2]** (**charged**) then **2S2** on landing for wall bounce
- Mega Timewinder at midscreen boomerangs and allows **j.H** extension into corner
- After corner tag combos: always end with **2S1** Toss for oki trap setup

7.6 Limit Break / Limit Strike Extensions

After Limit Strikes, the freeze window allows:

- **2S1** immediately after the freeze to place a Timewinder for oki on wakeup
- **S2+L** (Tangled Timeline) during the Limit Strike animation to enter the next round with Volatile Afterimage already installed
- Full Volatile Afterimage charge setup in the open frame window

Chapter 8

ARCHETYPE MATCHUP STRATEGIES

8.1 vs. Zoners

Zoners control fullscreen and beat Ekko in the poke war. He must get in to win.

- **Examples:** Jinx, Teemo
- **Down S2 projectile invulnerability:** 2S2 passes through most projectiles to close distance.
- **Roll approach:** Invincibility frames let you pass through horizontal projectiles.
- **Don't fight at fullscreen:** You lose the poke war. Get a knockdown and lock them into oki.
- **Forward Assist:** T travels far quickly, covering your approach from behind.
- **Punish whiffed projectiles hard:** Many zoner projectiles have high end lag.

8.2 vs. Rushdowns

Rushdown players want to stay in your face constantly.

- **Examples:** Vi, Darius
- **Anti-air consistently:** 2H into Limit Strike oki; reward yourself for anti-airs.
- **Parry bait:** S2 Hold/Release mixup counters aggressive players who Parry constantly.
- **Timewinder to decelerate pace:** A well-placed Timewinder forces them to respect the screen.
- **Back Throw:** Put them at fullscreen; combo into oki setup.
- **Backdash:** Create space and re-establish Timewinder control.

8.3 vs. Grapplers

Grapplers are deadly at close range; Ekko's mobility is his escape.

- **Examples:** Darius, Blitzcrank
- **Never stay at throw range:** Maintain poke distance at all times.
- **Heel Tap pressure:** 3L reaches far enough to poke without entering grab range.
- **Punish whiff grabs hard:** High end lag on grab whiffs means full BnB punish.
- **Air Hop to bait:** Hop over grab attempts and punish on landing.
- **Chronostrike crossup:** Push them to the corner where Ekko controls the game.

8.4 vs. Defensive / Turtle

- **Timewinder:** Force reactions; punish defensive responses.
- **Overhead conditioning:** Repeated low pressure, then Flip It when they crouch-block.
- **Tick throws:** Against opponents who respect blockstrings, mix in tick throws constantly.
- **Corner oki loop:** Extremely oppressive against turtles who won't risk reversals.

Chapter 9

INDIVIDUAL CHAMPION MATCHUPS

9.1 vs. Ahri

Key Threats:

- Fast consistent Orb projectile starts the poke war
- Foxfire dash punishes whiffs quickly
- Good mobility contests Ekko's approach angles

Counter-strategy:

- Use [2S2](#) (projectile-invulnerable) to go through her orbs
- Time Air Hop approaches to avoid orb trajectories
- Corner oki loop shuts down her mobility once landed
- Anti-air with [2H](#) on aerial dash approaches; leads to strong oki
- Forward Assist covers her escape dashes

9.2 vs. Blitzcrank

Key Threats:

- Rocket Grab from fullscreen; one hit is massive damage
- Power Fist overhead; unblockable while crouching
- Static Field knockback disrupts pressure

Counter-strategy:

- Never stand still at fullscreen; Rocket Grab hits stationary targets

- **S2 Hold** WINS vs. Blitzcrank **5L** on crossup
- Timewinder forces Blitzcrank to navigate it with slow movement
- Full BnB punish on any Rocket Grab whiff
- Air Hop over his head and avoids most of his ground toolkit

9.3 vs. Braum

Key Threats:

- Unbreakable shield deflects Timewinder; disrupts oki and neutral
- Stand Behind Me dash repositions quickly
- Slow but large hitbox normals

Counter-strategy:

- **S2 Hold** WINS vs. Braum **5L** on crossup
- Bait shield activation; punish when it is down
- Slow movement makes Air Hop crossups very effective
- **3L** Heel Tap pokes under his large body
- Corner trap is especially devastating; he struggles to escape

9.4 vs. Darius

Key Threats:

- Apprehend pull punishes whiffed normals from mid-range
- Noxian Guillotine massive damage at 5 stacks
- Hemorrhage chip means every hit hurts

Counter-strategy:

- Never throw out normals from pull range
- **3L** Heel Tap pokes outside of Apprehend range
- **S2 Hold** WINS vs. Darius **5L** on crossup
- When Darius has stacks: Pushblock and reset to neutral rather than contesting
- Air Hop over Apprehend attempts and punish on landing

9.5 vs. Illaoi

Key Threats:

- Harsh Lesson huge damage; lingering tentacle hitboxes on screen
- Armoured slam attacks resist pressure strings

Counter-strategy:

- Timewinder forces Illaoi to navigate with slow movement
- **S2 Hold** WINS vs. Illaoi **5L** on crossup
- Air Hop approaches confuse her grounded hitboxes
- Avoid Temporal Slip on armoured moves; she absorbs and punishes
- Corner Timewinder oki: she cannot Getup Attack through it

9.6 vs. Jinx

Key Threats:

- Fishbones rockets control fullscreen and the air
- Flame Chompers trap the ground
- S2 Hold only *trades* with Jinx **5L** on crossup (not a clean win)
- Mega Death Rocket punishes afterimage setups from fullscreen

Counter-strategy:

- **2S2** is **projectile-invulnerable**: go through rockets to close distance
- Stay airborne on approach to avoid Flame Chompers
- Air Timewinder catches her on the ground while you are safe in the air
- Get a knockdown; Ekko's oki is where he wins this matchup
- Call Chronostrike Assist forward to force two simultaneous threats

9.7 vs. Teemo

Key Threats:

- Noxious Trap mushrooms zone the entire screen
- Toxic Shot poison chip accumulates over the round
- Move Quick speed buff makes him hard to corner
- Blinding Dart removes Ekko's ability to land normals

Counter-strategy:

- Respect mushroom placement; do not walk into them on approach
- Air Timewinder from above avoids ground traps
- [2S2](#) projectile invulnerability goes through Toxic Shot
- Ekko's oki traps are devastating once you land a hit; focus on getting that first opening
- During Blinding Dart, Volatile Afterimage follow-ups are unaffected — continue the combo

9.8 vs. Vi

Key Threats:

- Vault Breaker armoured gap-closer punishes cautious play
- Excessive Force (explosion) big damage on full confirm
- Strong anti-air capability

Counter-strategy:

- Bait Vault Breaker and punish on whiff; significant end lag
- Avoid predictable jumps; use empty hop to bait her anti-air
- Roll to pass through charged Vault Breakers
- Timewinder oki interrupts Vi's offensive patterns on wakeup
- [2S2](#) passes through Vault Breaker armour

9.9 vs. Warwick

Key Threats:

- Infinite Duress grab Ultimate ignores block; must tech or jump
- Primal Howl fear interrupts Ekko's aggressive pressure strings
- S2 Hold only *trades* with Warwick [5L](#) on crossup
- Fury mechanic blocks all chip damage
- Blood Hunt speed buff at opponent low HP is terrifying

Counter-strategy:

- Use Timewinder to force reactions; deny his close-range game
- Avoid raw Chronostrike at close range; he can Primal Howl interrupt
- Do not attempt chip-kill strategies; Fury blocks chip
- At crossup: take the trade, then continue with [5L](#) > [BnB](#)
- Corner Timewinder oki: his large body makes Timewinder easy to hit

9.10 vs. Yasuo

Key Threats:

- Wind Wall (B.S2) blocks ALL of Ekko's projectiles including Timewinder and Mega Timewinder
- Last Breath combo off knockups is enormous damage
- Strong crossup game of his own

Counter-strategy:

- Track Wind Wall cooldown; when it expires go aggressive with Timewinder immediately
- Wind Wall now has reduced duration and increased cooldown (Season 1 nerf)
- Do not jump into Last Breath range when airborne from launcher
- **2S2** to go under or through Steel Tempest
- Afterimage setups confuse Yasuo's crossup reads; S2 Hold/Release baits his parry

Chapter 10

TEAM COMPOSITIONS AND SYNERGIES

10.1 What Ekko Wants in a Partner

- Cover his weak anti-air game
- Extend combo potential with strong assist links
- Complement mixup pressure with threatening assists
- Help close distance against zoners

10.2 Best Teams Overview

Ekko	Partner	Synergy
Ekko	Vi	Mobile duo; strong corner carry and mix-ups; SonicFox's main team
Ekko	Warwick	Wounded synergy; high damage; comeback potential
Ekko	Ahri	Dual projectile system; Ahri covers Ekko's approach routes
Ekko	Yasuo	Yasuo assists extend Ekko's combos perfectly; dominant duo
Ekko	Jinx	Zoning + mixup complement; Jinx range covers Ekko's shortcomings

10.3 Ekko / Vi

10.3.1 Why This Team Works

Both are fast and mobile; both excel in the corner. Their combined speed and combo potential make them one of the highest-output mobile duos in the game. This is also the team of SonicFox (2nd DreamHack Atlanta).

10.3.2 Role Distribution

- **Ekko (Point):** Use Timewinder to control space; land a hit; enter oki loop
- **Vi (Assist/Anchor):** Vault Breaker assist with armour covers Ekko's approach; on tag-in, Vi closes distance independently

10.3.3 Combo Synergy

Team Combo: Ekko/Vi (anywhere)

- 5L > 5M > 5H > T (Tag Launcher) > [Vi air combo] > Handshake Tag back to Ekko > j.H > j.6[S2] > 2S2 > BnB ender
- Tag Launcher allows Vi to extend the air combo and build meter before handing back.
- Vi's Excessive Force explosion can be OTG'd with Ekko's 2S2 on re-entry.

10.3.4 Neutral Strategy

- Vi Forward Assist for armoured gap closing while Ekko controls with Timewinder
- Sandwich: Ekko crosses up with 2S2, call Vi forward assist — Vi comes from the original side while Ekko is behind the opponent
- After Limit Strike: both characters have devastating corner-carry extensions

10.3.5 Defensive Strategy

- Vi's Vault Breaker (charged) has armour — use as a reversal option after Pushblock
- Tag to Vi when Ekko is at low HP for higher raw damage
- Vi's anti-air is better than Ekko's; use Vi Assist to cover aerial approaches

10.4 Ekko / Warwick

10.4.1 Why This Team Works

Warwick's **Wounded** mechanic activates at low HP, providing significant power boosts. Combined with Ekko's setup-heavy kit, this creates a late-game comeback threat.

10.4.2 Role Distribution

- **Ekko (Point):** Set up clones, Timewinder oki, land the first hit advantage
- **Warwick (Anchor):** Benefits from Wounded at low HP; Blood Hunt speed buff as anchor is terrifying

10.4.3 Combo Synergy

Team Combo: Ekko/Warwick (corner)

- 5L > 5M > 5H > 2S1 (Timewinder trap) > 2T (Tag Launcher) > [Warwick air combo] > Warwick Ultimate > Tag back Ekko > 2S2 OTG > BnB
- Warwick's grab Ultimate creates an unblockable situation during the freeze animation.
- After the Ultimate freeze, Ekko re-enters with 2S2 for continued pressure.

10.4.4 Neutral Strategy

- Warwick Assist adds pressure during Ekko's Timewinder oki loops
- Primal Howl assist interrupts opponents who try to counter-poke Ekko's strings
- Sandwich: Warwick Assist + Ekko Down S2 crossup for an almost unreactable left-right

10.5 Ekko / Ahri

10.5.1 Why This Team Works

Ahri covers Ekko's biggest weakness: zoning and space control. Her Orb projectile can complement Ekko's Timewinder for a multi-projectile pressure system at different heights.

10.5.2 Role Distribution

- **Ekko (Point or Flex):** Close range pressure, mixups, corner oki
- **Ahri (Assist/Point):** Orb of Deception covers Ekko's approach; Spirit Rush dash for mobility

10.5.3 Combo Synergy

Team Combo: Ekko/Ahri (anywhere)

- 5L > 5M > 5H > T (call Ahri) > Ahri j.Orb > 66 Handshake Tag to Ekko > j.H > j.6S2 > BnB
- Ahri's air orb creates a unique hitbox angle Ekko cannot replicate alone.
- Handshake Tag returns Ekko perfectly into forward air clone position.

10.5.4 Neutral Strategy

- Throw Timewinder + call Ahri Orb assist simultaneously: two projectiles at different screen heights
- Ahri Charm assist after Ekko blockstring forces difficult guard situation
- If Ekko is losing to a zoner, tag to Ahri who can out-zone most characters
- After Time-slow reaction: Ahri re-enters with Spirit Rush for high-damage conversion

10.6 Fuse Recommendations

Fuse	Rating	Notes
Pulse	Best	Long combo chains; Pulse rewards Ekko's chain-heavy style with no strict timing
Burst	Good	High-damage shorter confirms; complements S2 Super install routes
Double Down	Weak	S2 Super is already an install; no extra benefit. S1 combos do not need Double Down either.

10.7 Using Ekko as Assist

10.7.1 Forward Assist (My Time! — Forward T)

Primary and most used assist. Chronostrike travels a long distance across the screen:

- Covers point champion's approach and block strings
- On hit: **Handshake Tag** to Ekko and confirm into full combo
- Hard to react to due to travel distance and speed

10.7.2 Back Assist (Timewinder — Back T)

Use at *maximum range only*. When the slow hits, Time-slow reaction enables a huge combo. When it misses, the lingering projectile still controls the screen:

- Forces opponent to play around the slow-field
- Enables long-range tag combo from the Time-slow reaction
- Blocks Getup Attacks during point champion oki

Chapter 11

ADVANCED CONCEPTS AND TIPS

11.1 Afterimage Cancel Deep Dive

With an Afterimage active, virtually every move can be cancelled into follow-ups. This fundamentally changes how opponents approach defense:

- Normal move → Replay (attack from the afterimage side)
- Normal move → Time's Up! (rewind with launcher, adjustable direction)
- Block string pause → teleport to bait Parry → punish
- Bait the Pushblock, then teleport past it for a punish

11.2 Training Mode Optimization

Enable frame data visualization in 2XKO's training mode to see startup, active, and recovery frames in real-time. Visualize hitboxes (red) and hurtboxes (green), and check frame advantage after each interaction. This is the fastest route to locking in combo links and finding unsafe moves.

11.3 Common Mistakes to Avoid

- **Over-relying on anti-air:** 2H is poor — position to avoid needing it.

- **Forgetting Forward input for new clone:** **6S2** creates a new clone; **S2** / back **S2** returns to an existing one.
- **Ignoring range limitations:** Ekko's buttons are short. Never out-poke range-dominant characters.
- **Wasting Volatile Afterimage charges:** Tangled Timeline gives 5 moves; spend them on overheads, OTG pickups, and high-damage enders.
- **Temporal Slip in raw pressure:** Always have an Afterimage out before using **6S1** in blockstrings.
- **Trying to Replay out of failed throws:** This no longer works (Season 1 nerf). Adjust throw-pressure patterns.

11.4 Season 1 Patch Notes Summary (Version 1.1.3)

- **Backdash** slowed for Ekko (and Ahri, Warwick, Vi, Yasuo) — retreat is more honest
- **Heel Tap (3L)** hitstun +2 frames (was 13, now 15); less pushback on hit — better low confirm
- **Step Up (66H)** scaling: +1 per use instead of +3 — better combo filler
- **Replay out of failed throw** removed — no longer a low-commitment strike-throw
- **Chronostrike Assist** startup 17f → 19f; no longer gapless when doubled; range, hitbox, and distance all reduced
- **Timewinder Assist** startup 16f → 22f; less dominant at space control
- **Attempt #37 (Ultimate)** blockstun reduced by 6f — less safe on block
- **Chronobreak** meter gain reduced from 10 to 8 per use
- **Mega Timewinder** first hit now causes damage scaling — less damage off stray hits
- **Flip It (3M)** hitstun decreased on interrupt — now only combos into **5L** on interrupt
- **M range** slightly decreased

Chapter 12

QUICK REFERENCE

12.1 Essential Inputs Cheat Sheet

Action	Input	Use Case
Long-range low poke	3L	Heel Tap; go-to safe neutral poke
Overhead (with clone)	3M	Flip It; open crouch-blocking opponents
Timewinder (neutral)	5S1	Fullscreen control
Timewinder Toss (oki)	2S1	Oki setup from jump/arc
Temporal Slip	6S1	Advancing strike; use with afterimage backup
Clone (normal)	S2	Teleport back; standard pressure
Clone (volatile / hold)	[S2]	Unlocks OTG and overhead combos
Clone crossup	2S2	Projectile-invulnerable; crosses at close range
OTG pickup	2S2	With Volatile Afterimage only
Air Hop	L+M (air)	Forward only; bait anti-airs
S1 Super	S1+L/M/H	Mega Timewinder; midscreen boomerang
S2 Super (install)	S2+L/M/H	Tangled Timeline; 5 Volatile charges
Ultimate (3 bars)	S1+S2	Attempt #37; massive damage

12.2 Tiered Gameplan Checklist

Beginner Goals

- Learn Pulse Fuse combos (no strict timing required)

- Practice Timewinder at max distance for Time-slow confirms
- Get comfortable with basic **S2** → **r.S2** Replay sequence

Intermediate Goals

- Land Heel Tap (**3L**) into combo consistently
- Execute corner Timewinder oki trap after Forward Throw
- Learn S2 Hold vs. Release parry-bait mixup
- Incorporate **2S2** crossup into Assist sandwich
- Start conditioning opponents for Flip It overhead

Advanced Goals

- Convert off Forward Throw solo via Chronobreak OTG
- Perform full Tangled Timeline install combo with all 5 charges expended
- Execute Down S2 + Assist sandwich for the true left-right
- Optimise corner carry with charged air S2 wall bounce sequences
- React-confirm to Timewinder distance hits for extended conversions
- Exploit Temporal Slip 50/50 with Time's Up! under advanced pressure

This guide compiles information from Mobalytics.gg, Games.gg, 2xko.wiki, wiki.play2xko.com, and the official Riot Games 2XKO champion page. Data reflects Season 1, Version 1.1.3 (March 2026). Game data is subject to change with future patches.
